

Pre-attentive Attributes in Texts and Tables Transcript

Now, let us look at preattentive attributes in the text. First of all, text is also a form of presentation of the data or information. In fact, text is the most fundamental form of presenting information.

The same text without help of visuals can be made more effective by using some preattentive attributes. We will see them now. Look at the first paragraph on the right side.

It does not have any preattentive attributes and definitely would take some effort through glance through. Now, with the help of colour, we have highlighted a particular line trying to get more attention to that particular phrase in the paragraph. Then we have used size to make to get the similar effect on another phrase by increasing its size as compared to other text in the paragraph.

We have also done outline or enclosure on a particular phrase to get attention to that particular phrase. We can also use highlighting or bold on a phrase to get attention. We can also do that with italics combined with bold.

Then spatially we can separate and create a paragraph around a particular phrase to get attention. Finally, we can also underline and we can use a combination of these to get our attention increased to a textual body. We can use these features together to improve our attention on the body of the text.

For example, you can use colour and size together along with the bold if you want to highlight one particular phrase highest, lowest, the first rank, second rank or has the greatest number of sales. When we want to highlight particular phrases, we can use them or else we have used the text in the graphic, you might want to add colour to it to bring even more faster attention to that point. Again, a word of caution when using preattentive attributes, there has to be judiciousness.

We should not overdo them, we should not underdo them, they have to be in just right proportion without disturbing the basic feature of the visual so that the information flow is very smooth to the audience. Another preattentive attribute one can try out in text is building visual hierarchy. Here we will be again using size, colour and underlining highlighting to build a natural order into the text so that processing text becomes easier.

As far as the example on the slide is concerned, we are using blue colour to highlight certain key points followed by a light grey colour of the text. This naturally creates a hierarchy of preference or ordering within the text enabling the reader to pay attention to the parts that are highlighted first and then read the other parts. This would help the reader to get the parts to which the attention is sought for.



For example, I intend to highlight 4 or 5 points in the text, I can use a different colour and lighten the colour of the other text naturally the reader would pay more attention to the text that is highlighted. In this way we can highlight the text with the help of colour size or underlining to give more attention to certain aspects of the text.

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